Redwood Ecosystem Protection Case

South Fork Gualala River Watershed, California

Case Reference: THP #1-20-00203-SON → THP #1-25-00099-SON

Final Outcome: CASE WON – PROJECT HALTED

Executive Summary

This case successfully challenged unlawful timber harvesting in a federally impaired redwood watershed.

Through legal and ecological analysis, it was demonstrated that the Lucas Point THP was not a new project—but a segmented continuation of a previously defeated plan.

The ruling required full environmental compliance before any operations could proceed.

Timeline of Events

Key Legal Findings

1. Illegal Project Segmentation (CEQA)

Same landowner, site, and operations; refiled project treated as new; determined to be one continuous project.

2. Endangered Species Act Violations

Initial plan lacked protections; later additions prove prior knowledge; establishes non-compliance.

3. Clean Water Act Violations

Watershed impaired (303(d)); inadequate non-impact demonstration; sediment risk.

4. Formulaic Analysis

Identical language violates site-specific review requirements.

Legal Research Contribution

Comparative analysis identified identical operations, exposed segmentation, documented missing protections, and framed cumulative impacts.

You didn't just argue the case—you showed the pattern.

Environmental Significance

Old-growth redwoods, salmonid habitat, and endangered species corridors protected.

Final Outcome

Lucas Point THP deemed non-independent; review must be consolidated; operations halted.

Result: Project Halted. Environmental Protections Enforced.

Closing Statement

You cannot redesign paperwork to bypass environmental law. Substance wins over structure.